

The Conversation

06 · SALES

Serve, don't sell. A sale should be the natural outcome of a meaningful interaction.

WHY YOU ARE ALREADY GOOD AT THIS

Analysis of hundreds of thousands of recorded sales calls: the highest converters ask 11–14 questions, talk slightly less than half the time, and go deep on three or four problems. That is a description of a clinical assessment.

YOUR ACTUAL FAILURE MODE

Not being too pushy. Staying in assessment forever and never making an offer.

THE SHAPE

Open warm, set the agenda · where are they now and what is it costing · what do they want instead · what have they tried, what's in the way · what happens if nothing changes, in their words · what you do, briefly · the price, then silence · the ask.

THE TWO QUESTIONS THAT CATCH THERAPISTS

How is this different from therapy?

Therapy works on what's in the way; coaching works on where you're going. Structured, goal-led, with an end point

Could I just see you as a therapist instead?

Warm, and still no. Different work, different rules; mixing them wouldn't serve you. Offer to help them find somebody

HAND IT BACK

"My life is really busy." Not "it's quick and easy", but "you've told me how important this is — how would you make sure you had the time?"

THE SENTENCE PEOPLE FORGET

Would you like to do this? Most first conversations fail because nobody ever asked.

